

Samer Shawar

Senior Product Designer · UX/UI · HCI research · AI-powered products · Arabic and English

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PROFILE

Product designer with an HCI research background and a founder's view of what it takes to ship. I own the whole journey, from discovery and user flows through Figma prototypes to production screens and the handover to engineering, and I have done it as a co-founder, as the only designer on an enterprise SaaS product, and as a university researcher. I have designed an AI-guided emergency app end to end, data-heavy financial dashboards and Arabic-first bilingual interfaces, and I prototype in code (SwiftUI, ARKit, Claude Code) when Figma is not enough. Native Arabic, fluent English. M.Sc. in Human-Computer Interaction, one ACM publication.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Head of Product Design, Novaid · Nov 2024 – Present

Qatar Science & Technology Park · AI-guided emergency first aid, consumer iOS app with AR guidance, Arabic first · part-time advisory role since 2026

- Owned product and UX end to end: discovery with first responders and lay users, flows, Figma prototypes tested in simulated high-stress sessions, final screens, and handover to a three-person Agile team shipping to TestFlight.
- Designed the conversational AI experience: an LLM and RAG guidance layer that talks a user through an emergency, with explicit rules for what it says, when, how confident it sounds, and how it recovers when it is wrong.
- Built the Arabic-first design system and RTL/LTR component library in Figma from scratch, covering mobile and AR surfaces.
- Prototyped in Claude Code, SwiftUI and ARKit alongside Figma to get from concept to a testable build in days, and stayed with engineering through launch.
- As CEO, led QSTP incubation, seed-round preparation, and mapping the product against Qatar's national dispatch system and government procurement requirements.

Product Designer, Clove Digital · Mar 2022 – Oct 2024

Jerusalem · money-management SaaS for Amazon sellers: ad spend, budgets, inventory, reimbursements · 23 brands including Maple Holistics, Nature's Craft and Vitauthority

- Sole designer across four product areas in a cross-functional Agile team: contextual inquiry with sellers, user journeys and flows, wireframes, final UI, annotated Figma handover, and design QA through release.
- Designed data-dense financial dashboards and a guided reimbursement claim flow: views that surface the one figure needing a decision, with clear pending, settled, error and empty states.
- Built and scaled the Figma design system and component library; new-feature design time dropped by about a third.
- Ran A/B tests, usability sessions and eye-tracking studies; engagement on a core flow rose about 15%; brought core flows to WCAG 2.1 AA.

UX Mentor, Jerusalem High Tech Foundry · Jun 2022 – Feb 2024

- Mentored 10 emerging designers to job-ready level through critique and workshops on research, usability testing and Figma prototyping.

UX Research Assistant, Universität Siegen · Jul 2019 – Jul 2020

- Led user testing and journey mapping for research products on mobile and desktop; user-reported issues fell by more than half across iterations.
- Co-authored a peer-reviewed ACM paper on VR action research with user study design, data collection and analysis.

Research Intern, Waseda University, Tokyo · Oct 2018 – Jan 2019

- Worked on the kinematics of a saxophone-playing robot hand in a robotics lab, bridging mechanical constraints and human performance.

Founder, Vecbox, Ramallah · 2013 – 2017

- Ran a hackerspace and design-build studio; delivered 50+ web, interactive and physical projects for NGOs and companies.

EDUCATION

Doctoral research, Human-Computer Interaction, Universität Siegen, Germany · started 2020, currently paused

M.Sc. Human-Computer Interaction, Universität Siegen, Germany · 2017 – 2020

B.A. New Media, Musrara School of Art, Jerusalem · 2012 – 2015 · **B.A. Management Information Systems, Arab American University**

SKILLS

Product design and research: End-to-end user journeys · Discovery, interviews and contextual inquiry · Study design and eye tracking · User flows and wireframes · Information architecture · Interaction and visual design · High-fidelity UI · Usability and A/B testing · Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA) · Developer handover and design QA

Figma: Advanced prototyping · Component libraries and variants · Variables and tokens · Design systems built from scratch · RTL/LTR Arabic and English layouts

AI and emerging tech: Conversational and GenAI experience design · LLM and RAG product patterns · Designing confidence, uncertainty, fallback and error states · AR/spatial interfaces (ARKit, RealityKit) · AI-assisted research and prototyping (Claude, Claude Code)

Code: Enough to prototype and follow a build · SwiftUI · TypeScript · Python · Flutter · HTML/CSS **Ways of working:** Agile cross-functional teams · Founder-level ownership of scope and delivery · Explaining design decisions to engineers and business · Mentoring

PUBLICATION, CERTIFICATIONS AND LANGUAGES

Publication: Co-author, peer-reviewed paper on VR action research, ACM conference proceedings · **Certifications:** AI for Designers and Design Systems, Interaction Design Foundation · **Languages:** Arabic (native) · English (fluent) · German (basic)